

Euclid Book I: Reconstruction

CGJteamLab

August 7, 2026

Contents

1	Proposition I.1	1
1.1	The Classical Construction	1
1.2	Separating the Two Problems	3
1.3	Theorem	4
1.4	Proof	4
1.5	Architecture of the Proof	5
1.6	Significance of the Reconstruction	6
2	Proposition I.2	7
2.1	Statement	7
2.2	Euclid's Classical Construction	7
2.3	Hilbert Reconstruction	9
2.4	Formalization	10
2.5	Discussion	10
2.6	Book Zero #49: Layoff	10
3	Proposition I.3	12
3.1	Introduction	12
3.2	The Classical Construction	12
3.2.1	Final Configuration	12
3.2.2	Construction Algorithm	13
3.3	Proof	13
3.4	Proof Architecture	14
3.5	Hilbert Reconstruction	14
3.6	Lean Formalization	15
4	Proposition I.4	16
4.1	Introduction	16
4.2	The Classical Configuration	16
4.2.1	Final Configuration	16
4.3	Statement	17
4.4	Proof	18
4.5	Proof Architecture	18
4.6	Hilbert Reconstruction	19
4.7	Lean Formalization	19
5	Proposition I.5	20
5.1	Introduction	20
5.2	The Classical Configuration	20
5.2.1	Initial Isosceles Triangle	20
5.2.2	Extension of the Equal Sides	21
5.2.3	Choice of an Auxiliary Point	21

5.2.4	Construction of an Equal Segment	21
5.2.5	Auxiliary Joins	22
5.3	Statement	22
5.4	Proof	23
5.5	Implementation Architecture	23
5.6	Hilbert Reconstruction	24
5.7	Lean Formalization	25
5.8	Discussion	25
6	Proposition I.6	26
6.1	Introduction	26
6.2	The Classical Construction	26
6.2.1	Initial Triangle	26
6.2.2	Assuming Unequal Sides	26
6.2.3	The Auxiliary Triangle	27
6.2.4	The Contradiction	28
6.3	Statement	28
6.4	Proof	29
6.5	Implementation Architecture	29
6.6	Hilbert Reconstruction	29
6.7	Lean Formalization	30
6.8	Discussion	30

Chapter 1

Proposition I.1

Euclid's first proposition in Book I is usually presented as the straightforward construction obtained from the intersection of two circles. A formal reconstruction, however, reveals two logically independent problems: the existence of a common point of the corresponding circles and the proof that the resulting point does not lie on the line determined by the given base.

The proof of non-collinearity relies on the classical idea that a proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the entire segment. This argument is well known from modern axiomatic reconstructions of geometry, including the work of Michael Beeson and his collaborators.

The purpose of this note is not to present a new geometric proof. Rather, it is to demonstrate that, once Book Zero has been developed, this argument becomes a direct application of the previously established theory. Proposition I.1 therefore serves as the first experimental test of Book Zero as an intermediate language for synthetic proofs.

1.1 The Classical Construction

Let $A \neq B$. Euclid constructs two circles of radius AB : the first centered at A , the second centered at B . One of their points of intersection is denoted by C .

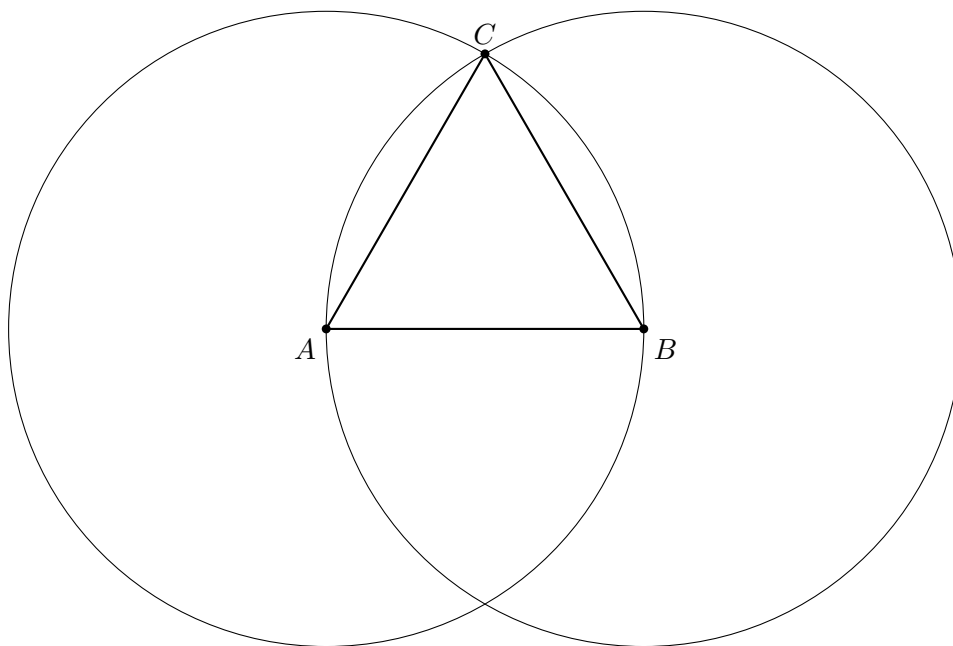


Figure 1.1: Euclid's classical construction. The point C is a common point of two circles of radius AB .

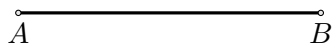
From the construction we obtain

$$AC \cong AB, \quad BC \cong AB.$$

Formally, however, this is not yet a complete proof. One must also show that the points A, B, C are not collinear.

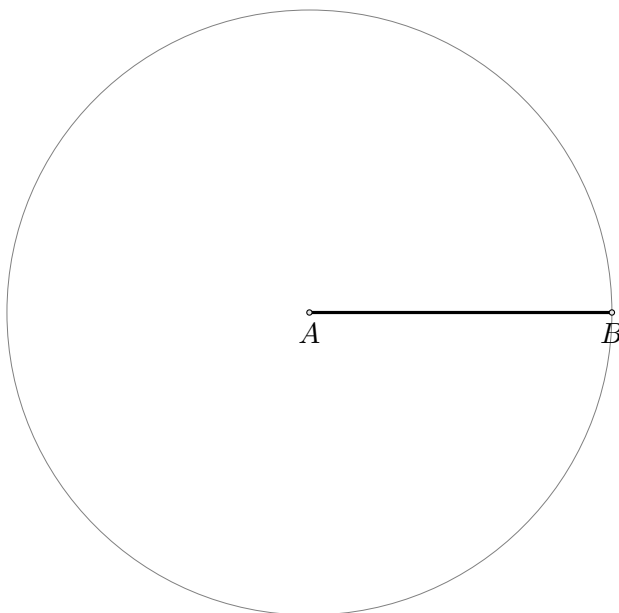
Step 1. Given Segment

The construction starts with a given segment AB .



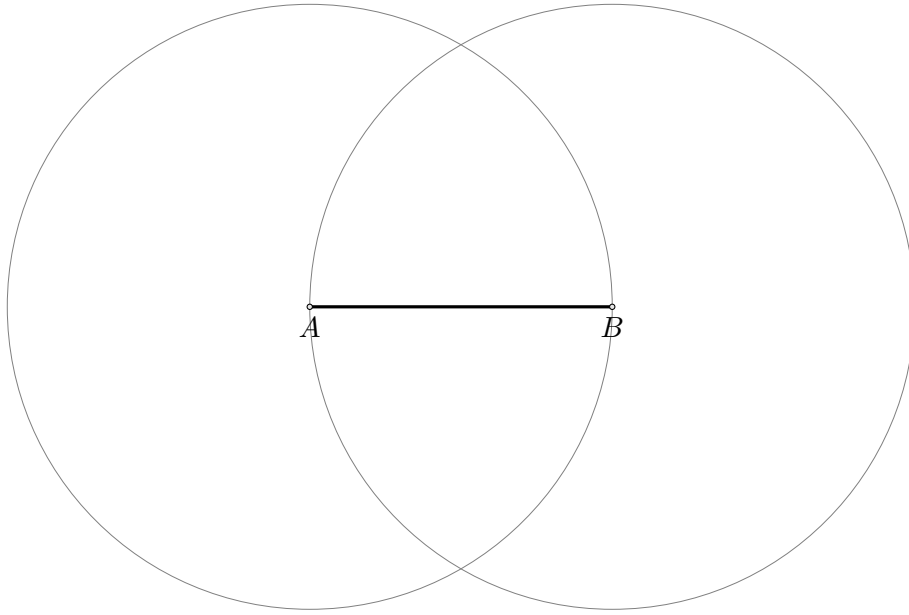
Step 2. Draw the Circle Centered at A

Draw the circle centered at A through B .



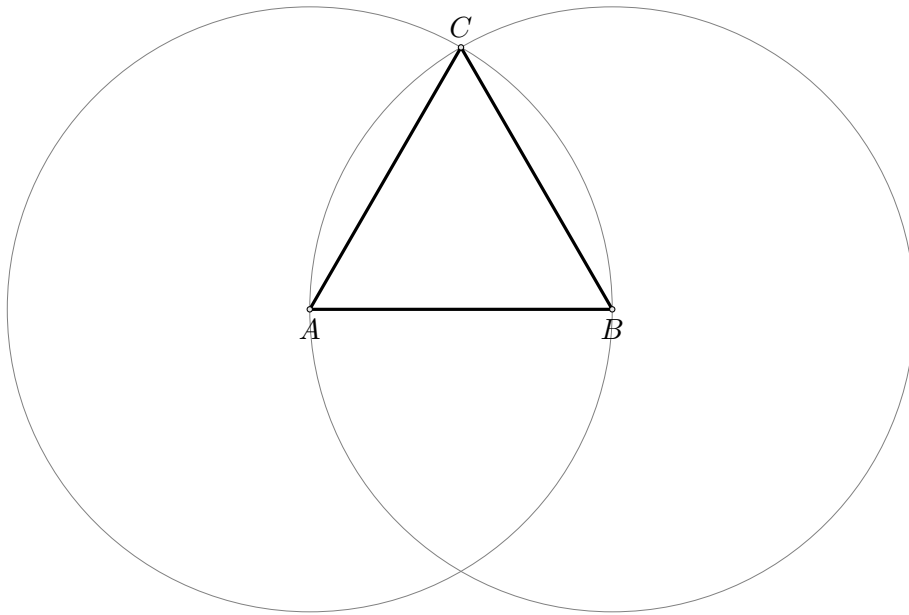
Step 3. Draw the Circle Centered at B

Draw the circle centered at B through A .



Step 4. Construct the Equilateral Triangle

Let C be one of the intersection points of the two circles. Join AC and BC to obtain the equilateral triangle.



1.2 Separating the Two Problems

The reconstruction reveals two logically independent stages.

1. **Existence stage.** One must obtain a point C such that

$$AC \cong AB, \quad BC \cong AB.$$

In the current version of the project, this stage is provided by the temporary principle `hilbert_equidistant_point_exists`. Ultimately, it is intended to be derived from an appropriate theory of continuity in Hilbert geometry.

2. **Synthetic stage.** From the congruences above one must derive

$$\neg \text{Collinear}(A, B, C).$$

This stage no longer requires any theory of circles.

1.3 Theorem

Theorem. Let $A \neq B$. Assume that there exists a point C such that

$$AC \cong AB, \quad BC \cong AB.$$

Then the points A, B, C are not collinear.

1.4 Proof

First observe that $C \neq A$ and $C \neq B$. If $C = A$, then $AC \cong AB$ would imply that a null segment is congruent to the non-null segment AB . Similarly, $C \neq B$.

Now suppose, for contradiction, that the points A, B, C are collinear. Since they are pairwise distinct, the trichotomy of the order of points on a line gives exactly three possibilities:

$$A - B - C, \quad B - A - C, \quad A - C - B.$$

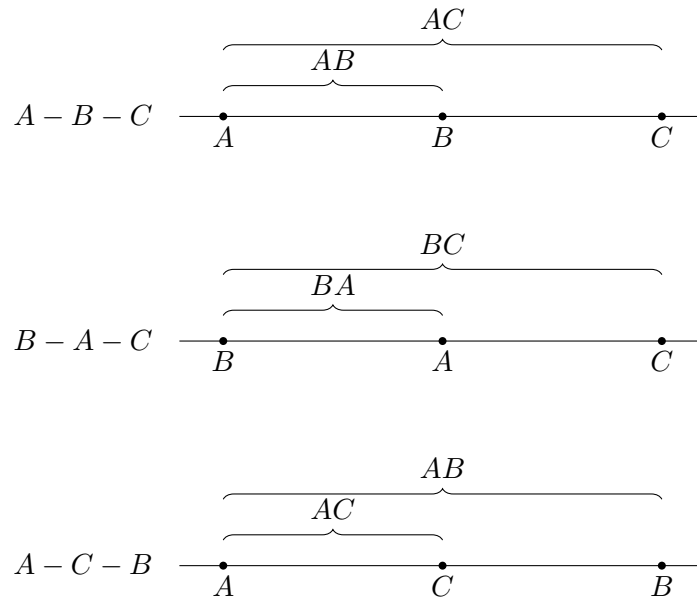


Figure 1.2: The three possible arrangements of pairwise distinct collinear points.

Case 1: $A - B - C$

The segment AB is a proper part of the segment AC . Book Zero contains the general theorem:

A proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the whole segment.

On the other hand, by assumption,

$$AC \cong AB.$$

Using symmetry of congruence, we obtain

$$AB \cong AC,$$

which is a contradiction.

Case 2: $B - A - C$

The segment BA is a proper part of the segment BC . Since

$$BC \cong AB,$$

and reversing the endpoints of a segment does not change its length, we have

$$BA \cong AB.$$

By transitivity of congruence, it follows that

$$BA \cong BC,$$

again contradicting the fact that a proper part cannot be congruent to the whole.

Case 3: $A - C - B$

The segment AC is a proper part of the segment AB . But the assumption directly gives

$$AC \cong AB.$$

This yields the third contradiction.

All possible collinear arrangements lead to a contradiction. Therefore,

$$\neg \text{Collinear}(A, B, C).$$

□

1.5 Architecture of the Proof

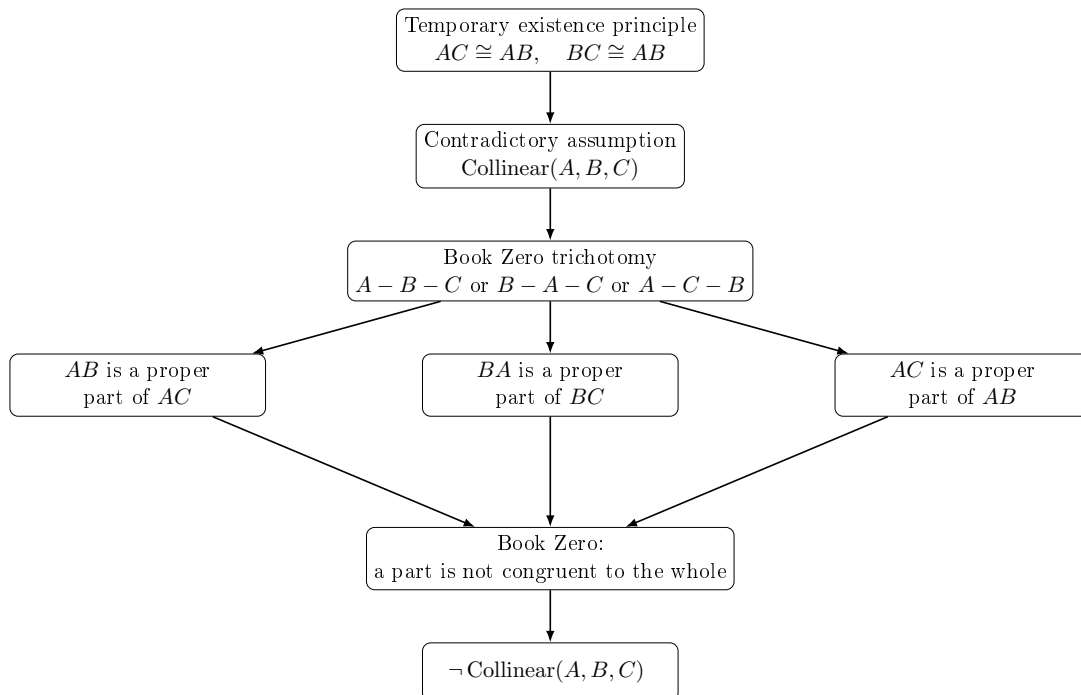


Figure 1.3: The structure of the proof of Proposition I.1 above the Book Zero layer.

1.6 Significance of the Reconstruction

The geometric result itself is not new. Constructing an equilateral triangle on a given segment is one of the classical theorems of elementary geometry.

Likewise, the idea underlying the proof of non-collinearity is not new. Modern axiomatic reconstructions, in particular the work of Michael Beeson and his collaborators, employ an analogous argument based on the theorem that a proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the entire segment.

The novelty of the present reconstruction lies elsewhere.

The objective of the CGJteamLab project was not to discover a new proof of Proposition I.1, but to investigate whether the theory developed in Book Zero is sufficiently rich to serve as an intermediate language for synthetic proofs.

The experiment shows that, once the existence problem for an equidistant point has been isolated, the entire argument can be expressed almost exclusively in terms of the theorems previously established in Book Zero.

From the perspective of the architecture of the theory, this is more significant than Proposition I.1 itself. It demonstrates that Book Zero is not merely a collection of auxiliary lemmas, but rather forms a new layer of abstraction between Hilbert's axioms and classical synthetic reasoning.

Schematically, the situation may be represented as

$$\text{Hilbert's axioms} \longrightarrow \text{Book Zero} \longrightarrow \text{Proposition I.1.}$$

In this sense, Proposition I.1 constitutes the first experimental test confirming that Book Zero can serve as a language of synthetic proofs for the further reconstruction of Euclidean geometry.

Chapter 2

Proposition I.2

This note compares Euclid's original construction for Proposition I.2 with its reconstruction over the Hilbert foundation. In the CGJteamLab development the proposition follows immediately from Book Zero #49 (Layoff), illustrating the difference between the architectural roles of segment construction in Euclid's geometry and the Hilbert axiomatic framework.

2.1 Statement

Given a point A and a segment BC , construct a point D such that

$$AD \cong BC.$$

2.2 Euclid's Classical Construction

Euclid's construction proceeds as follows.

1. Construct the equilateral triangle DAB on the segment AB .
2. Produce the side DB beyond B .
3. Produce the side DA beyond A .
4. Draw the circle centered at B with radius BC .
5. Draw the circle centered at D with radius DG .
6. The constructed point L satisfies

$$AL \cong BC.$$

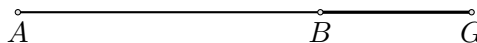
Step 1. Given data

The construction starts with a given point A and a given segment BG .



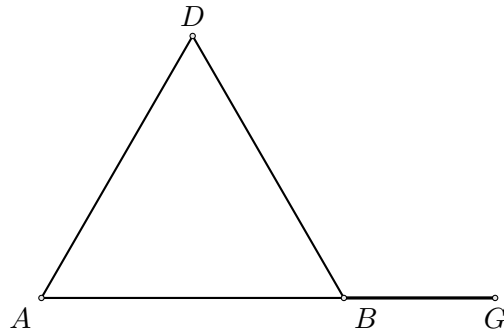
Step 2. Join AB

Join the given point A to the endpoint B of the given segment.

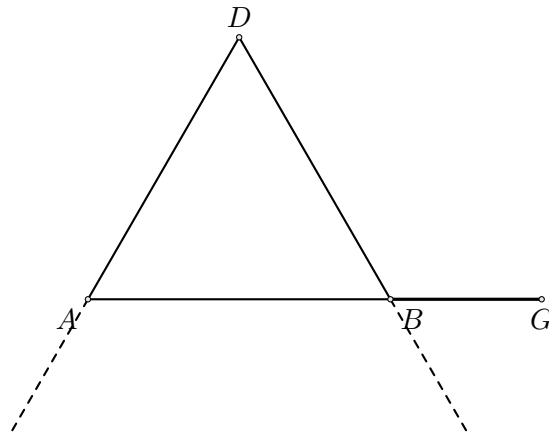


Step 3. Construct the equilateral triangle DAB

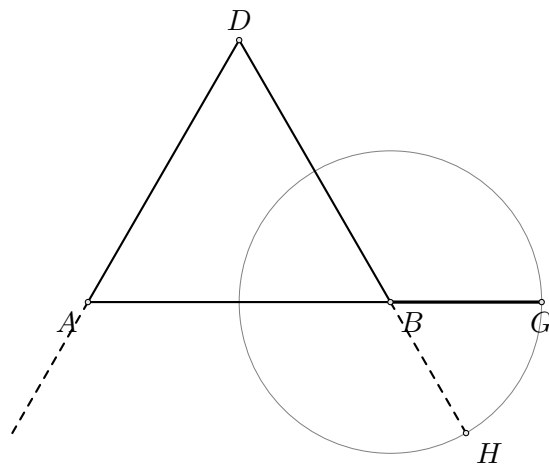
Construct the equilateral triangle DAB on the segment AB .

**Step 4. Produce DA and DB**

Produce DA beyond A and DB beyond B .

**Step 5. Draw the circle centered at B**

Draw the circle centered at B through G . Let H be the intersection of this circle with the line DB on the side beyond B .

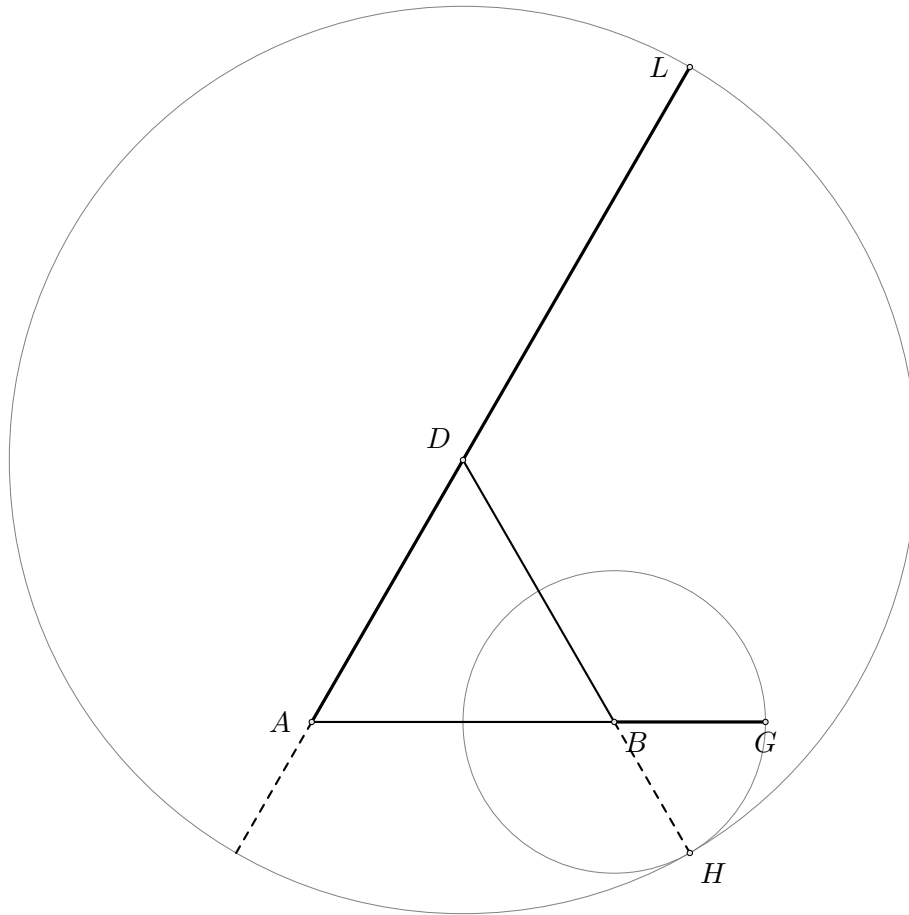


Since H lies on the circle centered at B through G ,

$$BH \cong BG.$$

Step 6. Draw the circle centered at D

Draw the circle centered at D through H . Let L be the intersection of this circle with the line DA on the side beyond A .



Since L lies on the circle centered at D through H ,

$$DL \cong DH.$$

The segment AL is therefore the required copy of the given segment.

2.3 Hilbert Reconstruction

The reconstruction over the Hilbert foundation is considerably shorter.

1. Choose any point $E \neq A$.
2. The ray AE is thereby determined.
3. Apply Book Zero #49 (Layoff).
4. Obtain a point D on the ray AE satisfying

$$AD \cong BC.$$

No auxiliary geometric construction is required.

Book Zero #49 provides a point D on a chosen ray from A such that

$$AD \cong BC.$$



Figure 2.1: Lay off the segment on a chosen ray.

2.4 Formalization

The formal proof consists of a single application of Book Zero #49.

```
theorem euclid_proposition_2 ...
  := bookZero_49_layoff ...
```

2.5 Discussion

Thus Proposition I.2 illustrates a fundamental architectural difference between Euclid's geometry and the Hilbert approach.

In Euclid's *Elements*, the transport of a segment is obtained through a sequence of explicit geometric constructions beginning with Proposition I.1.

In contrast, Hilbert incorporates this operation into the congruence axioms. Book Zero encapsulates it in the Layoff Theorem, making Proposition I.2 an immediate consequence.

2.6 Book Zero #49: Layoff

The proof of Proposition I.2 relies on one of the elementary construction theorems established in Book Zero.

Book Zero #49 (Layoff). Let $A \neq B$ and $C \neq D$. Then there exists a point X on the ray AB such that

$$AX \cong CD.$$

In other words, every nondegenerate segment can be copied onto an arbitrarily chosen ray while preserving its length.

Input

Ray AB

A----->

Segment CD

C-----D

|

| Book Zero #49

v

Output

A-----X----->

AX congruent CD

This theorem provides the fundamental operation of transporting segments. Once it is available, Euclid's Proposition I.2 becomes an immediate consequence.

Chapter 3

Proposition I.3

3.1 Introduction

Euclid's third proposition asks for the construction of a segment equal to a given shorter segment on a given greater segment.

Classically, this construction is obtained by combining Proposition I.2 with an additional circle construction. A segment equal to the shorter one is first laid off from an endpoint of the greater segment, and a circle is then used to determine the required point on the greater segment.

In the present reconstruction over Hilbert geometry, the logical structure is substantially different. The theory developed in Book Zero already contains an abstract notion of one segment being less than another. This notion is defined by the existence of a point between the endpoints of the greater segment such that the corresponding subsegment is congruent to the smaller one.

Consequently, the existential content of Euclid's Proposition I.3 is already embodied in the definition of segment inequality. The reconstruction therefore consists not in repeating Euclid's geometric construction, but in exposing the witness contained in the definition of `HilbertSegmentLess`.

This proposition provides the first clear example where a classical Euclidean construction becomes an immediate consequence of the abstract language developed in Book Zero.

3.2 The Classical Construction

Euclid's third proposition asks for the construction of a segment equal to a given shorter segment on a given greater segment.

Unlike Proposition I.2, the present construction does not introduce a new geometric technique. Instead, it combines Proposition I.2 with one additional circle construction.

The construction proceeds as follows.

3.2.1 Final Configuration

The objective is to determine a point E on the greater segment AB such that

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The final geometric configuration is shown in Figure 1.

From the construction we obtain

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The remaining task is to justify that the point E lies between the endpoints of the greater segment.

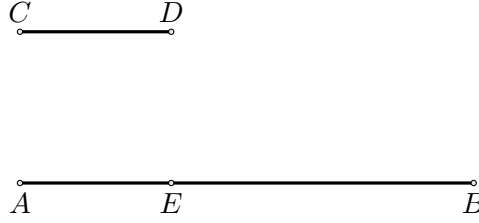


Figure 3.1: Final configuration of Euclid's construction for Proposition I.3.

3.2.2 Construction Algorithm

The construction uses Proposition I.2 as an already established construction primitive.

Step 1. Given Segments

Let AB be the greater segment and CD the given shorter segment.

Step 2. Apply Proposition I.2

By Proposition I.2, construct a segment AF congruent to the given segment CD .

Thus

$$AF \cong CD.$$

Step 3. Draw the Circle Centered at A

Draw the circle centered at A passing through F .

Step 4. Determine the Required Point

Let E be the intersection of the circle with the greater segment.

Since

$$AE \cong AF$$

and

$$AF \cong CD,$$

it follows that

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The required segment has therefore been obtained.

3.3 Proof

The classical Euclidean proof constructs the required point by applying Proposition I.2 and then introducing an auxiliary circle.

The reconstruction over Hilbert geometry follows a different logical route. The relation that one segment is less than another is already represented in Book Zero by the predicate

$$\text{HilbertSegmentLess } CD \ AB.$$

By definition, this predicate means that there exists a point E between the endpoints of the greater segment satisfying

$$A - E - B$$

and

$$AE \cong CD.$$

Therefore, assuming

$$CD < AB,$$

we immediately obtain a point E such that

$$A - E - B \quad \text{and} \quad AE \cong CD.$$

This is precisely the conclusion required by Proposition I.3.

Consequently, over the present Hilbert/Book Zero layer, the proposition is an immediate consequence of the definition of `HilbertSegmentLess`. □

3.4 Proof Architecture

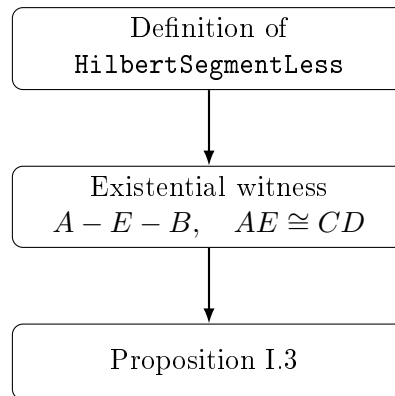


Figure 3.2: Logical structure of Proposition I.3 over the Book Zero layer.

3.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

Unlike Euclid's original proof, the present reconstruction does not repeat the geometric construction based on Proposition I.2.

The abstract notion of one segment being less than another has already been introduced in Book Zero by the predicate `HilbertSegmentLess`. By definition, this predicate contains exactly the existential information required by Proposition I.3.

Consequently, the reconstruction consists simply in extracting the witness from this definition.

This illustrates an important feature of the Book Zero layer. Classical geometric constructions are progressively replaced by abstract synthetic notions whose mathematical content has already been established.

3.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean formalization closely follows the mathematical argument.

The hypothesis

`HilbertSegmentLess` $CD\ AB$

already contains an existential witness providing the required point between the endpoints of the greater segment together with the corresponding congruence.

The formal proof therefore consists only of unpacking this witness and applying the symmetry of segment congruence.

Unlike the classical Euclidean proof, no additional geometric construction is required.

The resulting Lean theorem is therefore considerably shorter than the corresponding classical argument.

Chapter 4

Proposition I.4

4.1 Introduction

Euclid's fourth proposition is the first theorem on triangle congruence.

Unlike the preceding propositions, it does not describe a geometric construction. Instead, it establishes that two triangles are congruent whenever two corresponding sides and the included angle are equal.

Euclid's original proof relies on the method of superposition, one of the most discussed arguments in the *Elements*. Modern axiomatic systems generally avoid superposition as a primitive method of proof.

In the present reconstruction over Hilbert geometry, the proposition is obtained from the Side–Angle–Side (SAS) congruence theorem, which has already been established within the Hilbert theory.

Thus, while the mathematical content coincides with Euclid's Proposition I.4, the logical structure of the proof is fundamentally different.

4.2 The Classical Configuration

Unlike the first three propositions of Book I, Proposition I.4 is not a geometric construction. Instead, it establishes a criterion for the congruence of two triangles.

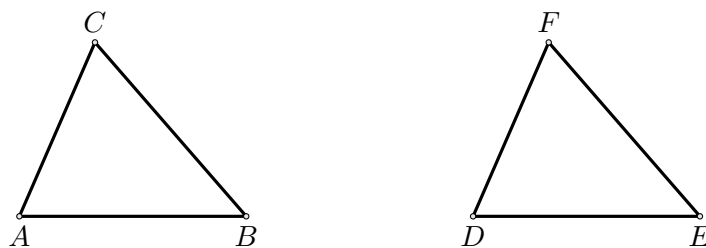
The proposition considers two triangles satisfying three geometric hypotheses:

- two pairs of corresponding sides are congruent;
- the included angles are congruent.

The objective is to prove that the triangles are congruent. As a consequence, the remaining corresponding side and the remaining corresponding angles are also congruent.

4.2.1 Final Configuration

The geometric configuration is shown in Figure 1.



Configuration of Proposition I.4.

The hypotheses are

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF.$$

The desired conclusions are

$$BC \cong EF,$$

together with

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

4.3 Statement

Proposition I.4.

If two triangles have two corresponding sides congruent and the included angles congruent, then the triangles are congruent.

More precisely, let ABC and DEF be two non degenerate triangles:

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF.$$

Then

$$BC \cong EF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

4.4 Proof

Euclid's original proof proceeds by superposition. One triangle is conceived as being placed upon the other in order to establish the coincidence of the corresponding sides and vertices.

The present reconstruction follows a different logical route. Superposition is not part of Hilbert's axiomatic system and therefore does not appear in the formal development.

Instead, the Side–Angle–Side congruence theorem has already been established within the Hilbert theory.

Applying the SAS theorem to the hypotheses

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF$$

immediately yields the congruence of the two triangles.

Consequently,

$$BC \cong EF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

This is precisely the conclusion of Proposition I.4.

□

4.5 Proof Architecture

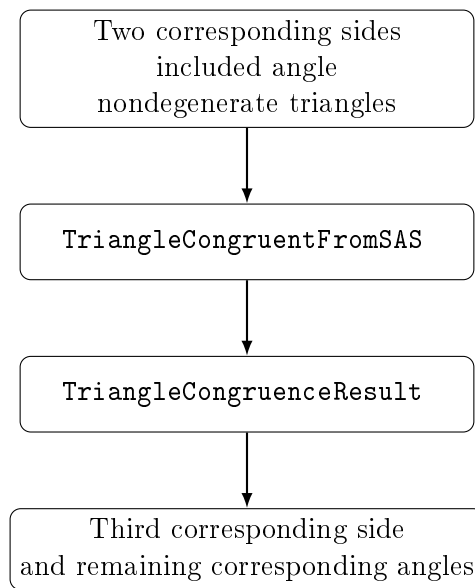


Figure 4.1: Logical structure of Proposition I.4 in the Hilbert reconstruction.

4.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The principal difference between Euclid’s original argument and the present reconstruction concerns the method of proof rather than the mathematical statement.

Euclid establishes Proposition I.4 by superposition, treating one triangle as if it could be placed upon the other. Although historically important, this method is not available within the Hilbert axiomatic framework.

Instead, the present development relies on the Side–Angle–Side congruence theorem, which has already been established as part of the Hilbert theory.

Once the hypotheses of the SAS theorem have been established, an application of `TriangleCongruentFromSAS` immediately yields the complete triangle congruence.

Thus the classical proposition is reconstructed without appealing to superposition while preserving exactly the same mathematical content.

4.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean theorem is a direct application of the previously established Hilbert SAS theorem, exposed through the compatibility theorem `TriangleCongruentFromSAS`.

In addition to the two side congruences and the congruence of the included angles, the formal statement explicitly records that both triples of vertices are noncollinear.

The theorem returns a value of type `TriangleCongruenceResult`. This structure contains the congruence of all three corresponding sides and all three corresponding angles.

Thus the formal proof of Proposition I.4 consists of a single application of `TriangleCongruentFromSAS`; no additional geometric argument is required.

From the viewpoint of formalization, Proposition I.4 is also the first result whose Lean proof is essentially a single application of a previously established interface theorem.

Chapter 5

Proposition I.5

5.1 Introduction

Proposition I.5 is the first theorem of Book I devoted specifically to the geometry of isosceles triangles. It establishes that the angles at the base of an isosceles triangle are congruent. Moreover, if the equal sides are extended beyond the base, the exterior angles formed by these extensions are also congruent.

In the Elements this proposition is one of the best known results of classical geometry and later became known under the traditional name *pons asinorum*. Although the theorem itself is elementary, it marks the beginning of a systematic study of congruence properties of triangles.

Euclid proves the proposition by combining the congruence theorem of Proposition I.4 with auxiliary constructions on the extensions of the equal sides.

In the present reconstruction the logical organization is different. The theorem is obtained by composing two previously established results of the Hilbert interface. The congruence of the base angles is provided by the theorem on isosceles triangles, while the congruence of the exterior angles follows from Hilbert's theorem on adjacent angles.

Consequently, Proposition I.5 is the first example in which a Euclidean proposition is reconstructed by combining several independent interface theorems rather than by introducing new geometric techniques.

5.2 The Classical Configuration

Euclid's proof of Proposition I.5 does not use only the original isosceles triangle and the extensions of its equal sides. It introduces additional auxiliary points and joins, producing a larger configuration to which Proposition I.4 can be applied.

Let ABC be an isosceles triangle satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Produce the equal sides AB and AC beyond the base vertices B and C . Euclid then chooses an auxiliary point on one extension, transfers a corresponding segment to the other extension, and joins the resulting points to the opposite vertices of the base.

The following sequence shows the successive stages of Euclid's configuration.

5.2.1 Initial Isosceles Triangle

The construction begins with an isosceles triangle ABC satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

At this stage no auxiliary points or segments have yet been introduced.

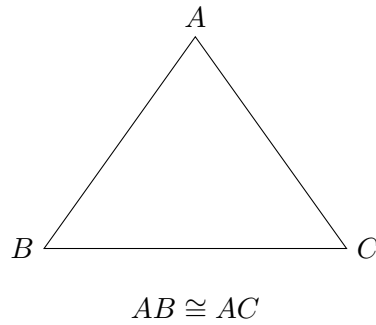


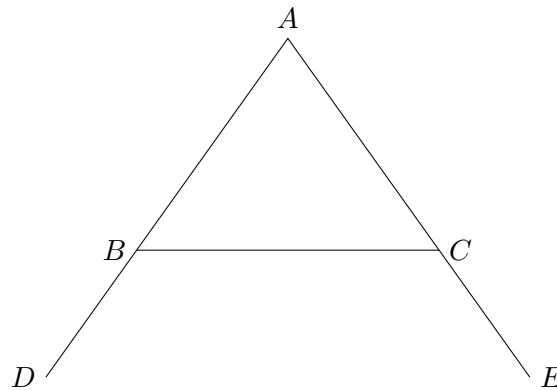
Figure 5.1: The initial isosceles triangle.

5.2.2 Extension of the Equal Sides

Euclid next produces the equal sides AB and AC beyond the base vertices. Let D lie beyond B on the line AB , and let E lie beyond C on the line AC .

Thus

$$A - B - D, \quad A - C - E.$$

Figure 5.2: The equal sides AB and AC produced beyond B and C .

5.2.3 Choice of an Auxiliary Point

Euclid now chooses an arbitrary point F on the extension BD of the side AB .

Thus

$$A - B - F,$$

with F lying on the ray from A through B beyond the base vertex B .

5.2.4 Construction of an Equal Segment

Using Proposition I.3, Euclid marks a point G on the extension of AC such that

$$AG \cong AF.$$

The two auxiliary points are now related by the equality of the segments measured from the common vertex A .

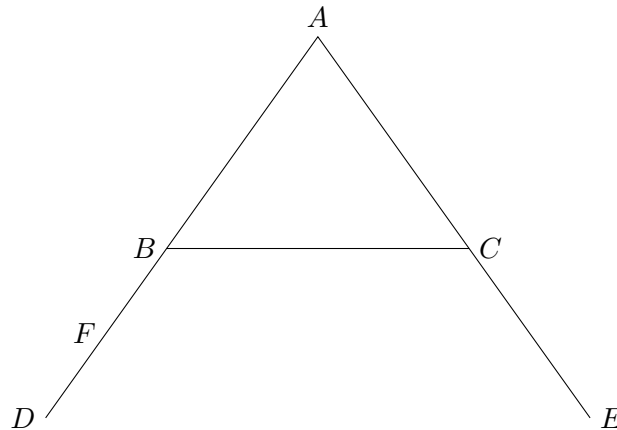


Figure 5.3: An arbitrary point F is chosen on the extension BD .

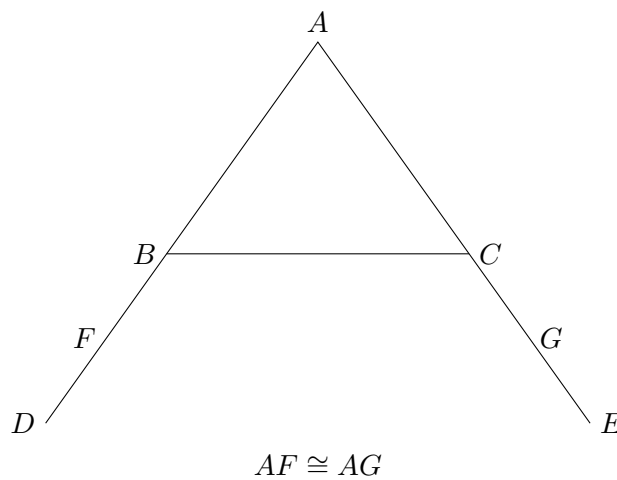


Figure 5.4: Construction of the equal segment $AG = AF$ using Proposition I.3.

5.2.5 Auxiliary Joins

The final step of Euclid's construction is to join the newly introduced points to the opposite vertices of the base.

The segments

$$FC \quad \text{and} \quad GB$$

complete the auxiliary configuration required for the proof.

5.3 Statement

Let ABC be a nondegenerate isosceles triangle satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Let the equal sides be extended beyond the base vertices so that

$$A - B - D, \quad A - C - E.$$

Then

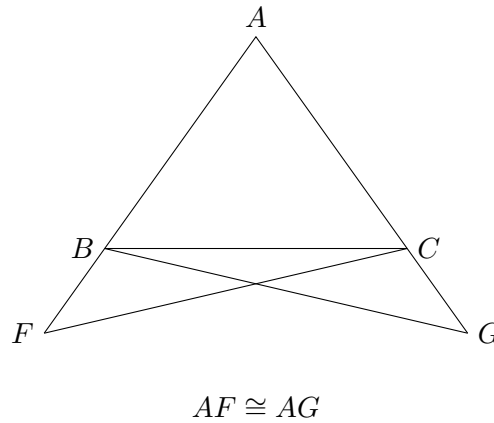


Figure 5.5: The complete auxiliary configuration used in Euclid's proof.

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

and

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

Thus both the base angles of the isosceles triangle and the exterior angles formed after extending the equal sides are congruent.

5.4 Proof

Euclid's proof is considerably more elaborate than the modern reconstruction presented later in this chapter. Rather than reasoning directly from the properties of an isosceles triangle, he introduces an auxiliary construction that allows repeated applications of the Side–Angle–Side congruence theorem established in Proposition I.4.

After extending the equal sides of the triangle, an arbitrary point is chosen on one extension. Proposition I.3 is then used to construct an equal segment on the opposite extension. The newly obtained points are joined to the opposite vertices of the base, completing the auxiliary configuration.

The proof proceeds by applying Proposition I.4 twice. The first application establishes congruence relations between the auxiliary triangles and yields equal corresponding sides and angles. These newly obtained equalities provide the hypotheses required for a second application of Proposition I.4.

Finally, Euclid combines the resulting congruence relations with the elementary properties of equal segments and equal angles to conclude that the interior base angles of the original isosceles triangle are congruent. The same argument immediately establishes the congruence of the corresponding exterior angles formed after extending the equal sides.

The auxiliary construction is therefore not an end in itself. Its sole purpose is to transform Proposition I.5 into two successive applications of Proposition I.4, allowing the theorem to be derived using only previously established geometric results.

5.5 Implementation Architecture

The formal proof of Proposition I.5 is obtained by composing two previously established theorems of the Hilbert interface.

The first theorem establishes the congruence of the base angles of an isosceles triangle. The second theorem transfers this congruence to the adjacent exterior angles after the equal sides have been extended.

The resulting logical dependency is shown below.

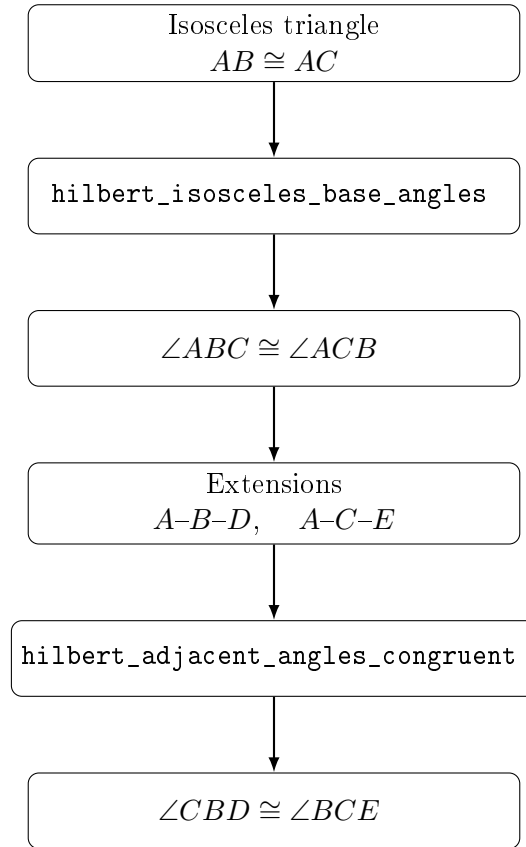


Figure 5.6: Implementation architecture of Proposition I.5.

Unlike the classical proof of Euclid, the formal development does not repeat the geometric argument establishing the base-angle theorem. Instead, the proposition is reconstructed by composing two independent results already available in the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.5 illustrates the modular nature of the library: new Euclidean propositions are obtained by combining previously verified synthetic theorems.

5.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The reconstruction of Proposition I.5 differs significantly from the classical proof presented in the *Elements*. Rather than repeating Euclid’s geometric argument, the result is obtained by combining two previously established theorems of the Hilbert interface.

The first theorem,

`hilbert_isosceles_base_angles,`

states that the base angles of a nondegenerate isosceles triangle are congruent. Applied to the hypothesis

$$AB \cong AC,$$

it immediately yields

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB.$$

The second theorem,

`hilbert_adjacent_angles_congruent`,

uses the betweenness relations describing the extensions of the equal sides to transfer this congruence to the corresponding exterior angles.

Consequently,

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

The reconstruction therefore introduces no new geometric machinery. Proposition I.5 is obtained entirely by composing two fundamental results already available in the Hilbert interface.

5.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation follows the mathematical reconstruction directly.

The theorem first applies `hilbert_isosceles_base_angles` to obtain the congruence of the base angles of the isosceles triangle.

The resulting angle congruence is then supplied to `hilbert_adjacent_angles_congruent`, together with the two betweenness hypotheses describing the extensions of the equal sides.

The theorem therefore returns both conclusions of Proposition I.5:

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

and

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

Unlike Proposition I.4, whose formal proof consists of a single application of the SAS theorem, Proposition I.5 is the first Euclidean proposition reconstructed as a composition of multiple interface theorems.

5.8 Discussion

Proposition I.5 marks an important transition in the reconstruction of Book I.

The earlier propositions are centred on elementary constructions and a single application of the SAS theorem. Beginning with Proposition I.5, most subsequent propositions of Book I are expected to be reconstructed by composing previously established interface theorems.

This modular organization differs substantially from the presentation of the *Elements*. Euclid develops each proposition as an independent geometric argument, whereas the present reconstruction emphasizes reusable formal components. The resulting proofs are shorter, their logical dependencies are explicit, and each proposition becomes a thin verification layer built upon the synthetic theory already developed in the Hilbert interface.

Chapter 6

Proposition I.6

6.1 Introduction

Proposition I.6 establishes the converse of the preceding proposition. Where Proposition I.5 proves that equal sides of a triangle imply equal base angles, Proposition I.6 shows that equal base angles imply the equality of the opposite sides.

This result completes the fundamental correspondence between the sides and angles of an isosceles triangle. Together, Propositions I.5 and I.6 establish the equivalence between the two defining properties of an isosceles triangle.

Euclid's original proof is considerably more involved than the modern reconstruction. It proceeds by contradiction, introducing an auxiliary construction obtained from Proposition I.3 and ultimately deriving an impossible configuration by repeated use of Proposition I.4.

In the Hilbert reconstruction developed in this project, the theorem admits a substantially shorter proof. The previously established Angle–Side–Angle theorem is sufficient to derive the equality of the opposite sides directly, eliminating the auxiliary construction and the *reductio ad absurdum* argument required by Euclid.

6.2 The Classical Construction

Euclid's proof begins with a triangle whose base angles are assumed to be equal. The desired conclusion is that the opposite sides are also equal.

Instead of arguing directly, Euclid assumes that the two sides are unequal and derives a contradiction. The proof therefore combines an auxiliary construction with a *reductio ad absurdum* argument.

The following sequence illustrates the successive stages of Euclid's construction.

6.2.1 Initial Triangle

Let ABC be a triangle satisfying

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB.$$

At this stage no auxiliary construction has yet been introduced.

6.2.2 Assuming Unequal Sides

To obtain a contradiction, Euclid assumes that the two sides opposite the equal angles are not equal. Without loss of generality, suppose

$$AB > AC.$$

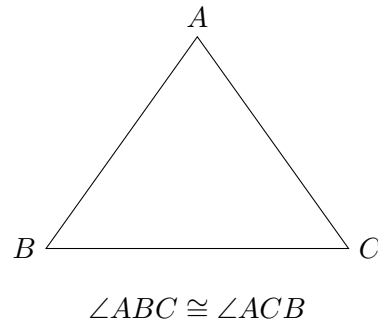


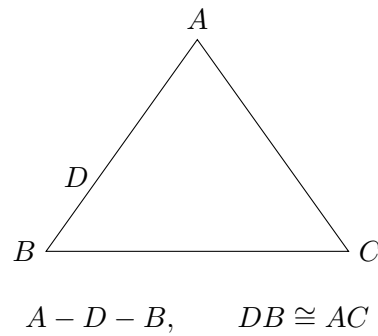
Figure 6.1: The initial triangle with equal base angles.

Using Proposition I.3, a point D is chosen on the segment AB so that

$$DB \cong AC.$$

Consequently,

$$A - D - B.$$

Figure 6.2: Assuming $AB > AC$, Proposition I.3 constructs D on AB with $DB = AC$.

6.2.3 The Auxiliary Triangle

The auxiliary point is joined to the remaining vertex of the original triangle.

Since

$$DB \cong AC,$$

and the angle

$$\angle DBC$$

coincides with the original angle

$$\angle ABC,$$

the auxiliary triangle is prepared for an application of Proposition I.4.

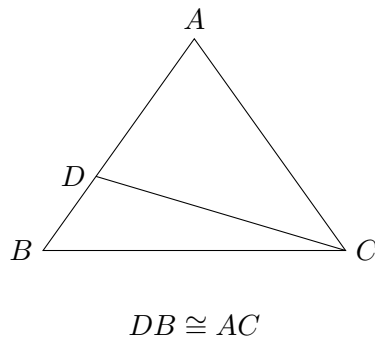


Figure 6.3: The auxiliary triangle DBC obtained after joining D to C .

6.2.4 The Contradiction

Applying Proposition I.4 to the triangles DBC and ACB establishes their congruence. Consequently, the corresponding angles and sides are equal.

Since the point D lies between A and B , one of the resulting equalities contradicts the assumption that the whole segment AB is strictly greater than its proper part DB .

The contradiction shows that the assumption

$$AB > AC$$

is impossible. By symmetry, neither side can be greater than the other, and therefore the two sides are equal.

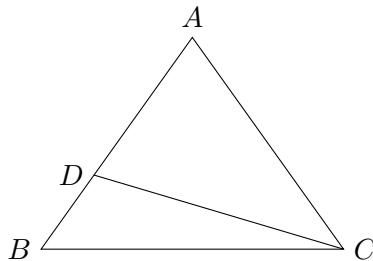


Figure 6.4: The auxiliary configuration from which Proposition I.4 forces a contradiction with the assumption $AB > AC$.

6.3 Statement

Theorem 1 (Euclid I.6). *Let ABC be a nondegenerate triangle.*

If

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

then

$$AB \cong AC.$$

That is, equal angles in a triangle subtend equal opposite sides.

6.4 Proof

Euclid proves the theorem by contradiction.

Assume that the sides opposite the equal angles are unequal. Without loss of generality, suppose that AB is greater than AC . By Proposition I.3, a point is constructed on the longer side so that the remaining segment is equal to the shorter side.

Joining the auxiliary point to the remaining vertex produces a second triangle. Proposition I.4 is then applied to show that the auxiliary triangle is congruent to the original one.

The resulting congruence forces equalities that are incompatible with the assumption that one side is strictly longer than the other. Since the assumption leads to a contradiction, the two sides must be equal.

Thus equal angles in a triangle necessarily subtend equal opposite sides.

6.5 Implementation Architecture

The formal proof follows a substantially different route from Euclid's classical argument. Rather than introducing an auxiliary point, constructing additional triangles, and reasoning by contradiction, the implementation exploits a higher-level theorem already available in the Hilbert interface.

The proof compares the given triangle with itself after exchanging the roles of the two equal angles. Since the common side is trivially congruent to itself, the derived Angle–Side–Angle theorem immediately implies the equality of the remaining sides.

Consequently, the entire classical construction disappears from the formal proof and is replaced by a single application of a previously established congruence theorem.

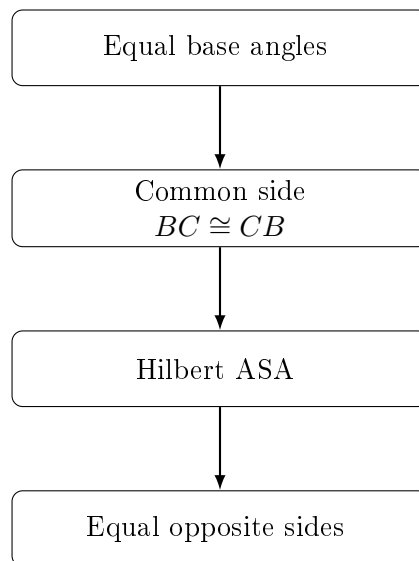


Figure 6.5: Architecture of the formal reconstruction of Proposition I.6.

6.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The formal reconstruction replaces Euclid's indirect argument by a direct consequence of the developed Hilbert theory.

The key observation is that the given triangle can be compared with itself after exchanging the two equal base angles. The side BC is common to both descriptions of the triangle and is therefore congruent to itself.

The hypotheses of the derived Angle–Side–Angle theorem are thus immediately satisfied:

$$\triangle BCA \longleftrightarrow \triangle CBA.$$

Applying the Hilbert ASA theorem yields the congruence of the remaining corresponding sides,

$$BA \cong CA,$$

which is equivalent to

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Unlike Euclid’s original proof, no auxiliary construction, no appeal to Proposition I.3, and no proof by contradiction are required. The entire argument is reduced to a single application of a previously established triangle congruence theorem.

6.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation closely follows the Hilbert reconstruction.

The proof first rewrites the given triangle by exchanging the roles of its equal base angles. The common side BC is identified with itself using reflexivity of segment congruence, while standard symmetry properties convert the supplied angle congruence into the orientation required by the Angle–Side–Angle theorem.

A single application of the derived theorem `hilbert_asa_sides` then establishes the congruence of the remaining sides. Finally, elementary symmetry of segment congruence rewrites the result into the statement of Proposition I.6.

Compared with Euclid’s original argument, the formal proof is substantially shorter because it relies on previously developed interface theorems rather than reconstructing the auxiliary geometric configuration.

6.8 Discussion

Proposition I.6 provides one of the clearest examples of the difference between a classical geometric proof and its modern formal reconstruction.

Euclid establishes the theorem by introducing an auxiliary point, constructing an additional triangle, and arguing by contradiction. The proof occupies a central place in Book I because it demonstrates how previous propositions can be combined to derive a converse statement.

Within the Hilbert framework, the same mathematical result becomes an almost immediate consequence of the previously established Angle–Side–Angle theorem. Once ASA has been derived from Hilbert’s axioms, the converse property of isosceles triangles follows directly, without auxiliary constructions or *reductio ad absurdum*.

This proposition therefore illustrates an important principle of the CGJteamLab reconstruction: as the interface theory grows, increasingly complex classical arguments collapse into short applications of high-level synthetic theorems.

Bibliography

- [1] Euclid, *The Thirteen Books of Euclid's Elements*, edited and translated by Sir Thomas L. Heath, 3 vols., Dover Publications, New York, 1956. (Reprint of the second edition, Cambridge University Press, 1926.)
- [2] Euklides, *Elementy*, opracowanie i tłumaczenie: Piotr Błaszczyk, Kazimierz Mrówka, Copernicus Center Press, Kraków, 2014.
- [3] David Hilbert, *Grundlagen der Geometrie*, B. G. Teubner, Leipzig, 1899.
- [4] Marvin Jay Greenberg, *Euclidean and Non-Euclidean Geometries: Development and History*, 5th ed., W. H. Freeman, New York, 2010.
- [5] Michael Beeson and Larry Wos, “Axiomatizing Geometry,” *Annals of Mathematics and Artificial Intelligence*, 2019.
- [6] Michael Beeson, *A Constructive Version of Tarski's Geometry*, Annals of Pure and Applied Logic, Vol. 166, No. 11, pp. 1199–1273, 2015.